



# ARUN ANANDAN

Product Owner -  
Consulting Manager

## Contact

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## Websites, Portfolios, Profiles

- [linkedin.com/in/arun-anandan-safe-popm-77a35b16](https://www.linkedin.com/in/arun-anandan-safe-popm-77a35b16)

## Skills

- Payments: Merchant Acquiring, Issuing, PayFac, IPG

Results-driven Product Owner and Business Analyst with 18 years of experience in payments, banking, and digital commerce. Expertise in merchant acquiring, BASE24, ISO 8583, ISO20022 and omnichannel payment flows. Skilled in transforming complex regulatory and business requirements into scalable products using Agile/SAFe methodologies. Experienced in pricing, billing, API orchestration, and fintech integrations.

## Work history

2023-01 -  
Current

### Product Owner / Consulting Manager – Cards Payments Practice

*Virtusa, Chennai*

#### Virtusa Corporation | Product Owner / BFS Payments Consultant

Worked with leading financial institutions including **Fiserv, PNC Bank, and CSG International**, delivering payments modernization, merchant acquiring transformation, digital banking, pricing platforms, AI-led innovation, and customer identity management initiatives.

- Led product and consulting engagements across **Merchant Services, Cross-Border Payments, Digital Banking, CIAM, and Core Banking modernization** programs.

Supported ISO 20022 payment transformation initiatives through business analysis and message lifecycle mapping. Facilitated MT to MX migration concepts, including PACS.008, PACS.009, and PACS.002. Managed exception handling for SWIFT MT103 migration and SEPA payments. Executed payment investigations, reversals, recalls, and settlement flows. Streamlined payment status reporting processes within the payment engine using TCS Bancs, GMTS, and EMTS. Converted direct messaging formats with Translator SAA SMH for enhanced communication. Implemented instant payments solutions through GIP for efficient fund management.

- Managed pricing, charging, and billing transformation programs for merchant services, defining fee management models across subscription-based, usage-based, tiered, and dynamic pricing structures.

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Payment Processing Standards</li> <li>• Card Payments Strategy</li> <li>• Banking &amp; BFS Platforms: Teller, P2P, Zelle, Bill Pay</li> <li>• Agile product ownership</li> <li>• Roadmap management</li> <li>• API &amp; Integration: REST, Swagger, ESF, Finxact</li> <li>• Pricing and billing</li> <li>• AI enablement</li> <li>• Stakeholder engagement</li> </ul> |                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Served as Product Owner for <b>PNC Bank CIAM modernization</b>, leading Ping Identity to Transmit Security migration, authentication services, API integrations, production support, stakeholder governance, deployments, and executive reporting.</li> <li>• Facilitated <b>Agentic AI and Generative AI proof-of-concepts</b> focused on ACH operations, fraud analytics, transaction monitoring, payment exception management, business process automation, and digital transformation initiatives. Collaborated with E-commerce and SAP teams on AI-driven personalization, workflow automation, and customer engagement use cases.</li> <li>• Delivered merchant acquiring solutions using <b>BASE24, ISO 8583, and Internet Payment Gateway (IPG)</b> integrations, ensuring transaction compliance, validation, performance optimization, and omnichannel payment processing.</li> <li>• Payment360, <b>Zelle, Bill Pay, Teller Banking, and Finxact Core Banking</b> programs supporting P2P, B2B, and B2C payment journeys and omnichannel customer experiences.</li> </ul> |
| <div>Languages</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <div>English</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <div>Tamil</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <div>2020-10 - 2023-01</div> | <div>Senior Business Analyst / Product Owner</div> <div>SAI Digital, Chennai</div> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Owned product delivery from discovery to post-production support across B2C and B2B commerce platforms.</li> <li>• Translated business vision into product roadmaps, user stories, and sprint goals.</li> <li>• Authored functional, technical, and non-functional acceptance criteria for SAP Cloud integrations.</li> <li>• Led backlog grooming, sprint planning, reviews, retrospectives, and technical debt management.</li> <li>• Delivered client demos, training sessions, and user documentation.</li> <li>• Enabled digital marketing automation using SAP Marketing Cloud and Analytics Cloud.</li> <li>• Optimized customer engagement through campaign performance analysis (Email, SMS, Google, Facebook).</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

- Platforms: SAP Commerce (Hybris), Magento, SAP Marketing Cloud, SAP Analytics Cloud

2016-10 -  
2020-10

## **Business Analyst – Cards & Payments**

*Wirecard, Chennai*

- Delivered card issuing and acquiring solutions across prepaid and multicurrency programs.
- Led migration from VPS to Corecard for major banking clients including ANZ, UAE banks.
- Contributed to CCP migration using Kafka-based middleware integrating with T24 core banking.
- Worked on Wireconnect APIs, microservices validation, tokenization, and UPI flows.
- Acted as Scrum Master across Agile and Kanban delivery models.
- Strong hands-on experience with ISO 8583, CAMT, SEPA message formats.

2015-08 -  
2016-09

## **Senior QA / Business Analyst**

*BORN Group, Chennai*

- Worked closely with clients and product teams to translate eCommerce business requirements into testable functional flows across Hybris and Magento platforms.
- Led QA planning, estimations, and execution while contributing to requirements analysis, user journeys, and defect triage.
- Supported omnichannel commerce validation across web and mobile, strengthening transition from QA leadership to BA responsibilities.

2014-03 -  
2015-08

## **Test Specialist**

*STAG Software, Bangalore*

- Delivered functional and integration testing for Internet Payment Gateway (IPG) solutions supporting Internet, mobile, and terminal-based transactions.
- Validated ISO 8583 message flows, EMV and non-EMV card transactions across Ingenico and Verifone terminals.
- Ensured end-to-end payment lifecycle accuracy including authorization, reversal, settlement, and reconciliation.

- (Client: Atos Worldline)

2012-07 -  
2014-03

## Senior Test Engineer

*Adecco, Bangalore*

- Led system, regression, and UAT testing for Target.com eCommerce and internal enterprise platforms across US and Canada.
- Coordinated QA activities, test planning, and execution while mentoring junior team members.
- Ensured release quality for high-traffic retail events, promotions, and campaign-driven platform changes.
- (Client: Target Corporation)

2008-06 -  
2012-06

## Test Analyst

*TCS, Chennai*

- Executed functional, regression, and UAT testing for media measurement and market research platforms to validate software performance and reliability.
- Collaborated with onsite and offshore stakeholders to analyze requirements, enhancing data accuracy and ensuring reporting integrity.
- Recognized for consistent delivery excellence, earning Star Performer and Performance Linked Awards.
- (Client: Nielsen)

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## Education

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### MBA: Marketing & Human Resources

*Sathyabama University - Chennai, India*

### Bachelor's Degree: Design & Visual Communication

*University of Madras - Chennai, India*

### Higher Secondary Education: 12th Standard

*St.Bedes Anglo Indian Higher Secondary School - Chennai, India*

## Secondary School Education: 10th Standard

*St. Anthony's Anglo Indian High School - Chennai, India*

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### Certifications

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SAFe Product Owner / Product Manager (POPM)

Certified Kanban Associate

GenAI Consultant Program – Virtusa Consulting Services

CBAP Certification – Virtusa Consulting Services

GenAI Assisted Engineer Program - Virtusa Consulting Services

Product Management for AI & Data Science

SAP Certified Technology Associate – Hybris Marketing Cloud

SAP Certified Application Associate – SAP Commerce Cloud